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N

nation

A **nation** is a group of people who belong together. These people usually live in the same country and have the same ruler.

Sometimes people use the word nation to refer to a people group who have something in common, even if those people do not have a king or a country. A people group may be [descendants](#) from the same person or share a similar purpose. For example, the nation of [Israel](#) was a people group before they had their own land or [king](#) because the [Israelites](#) were all descendants of the same man. The nation of Israel was also a nation because God chose the Israelites to be God's special people. Sometimes translations simply call these kinds of groups "people." The Israelites especially liked to call themselves the "people of [Yahweh](#)," or the "people of Israel," rather than a nation. The Israelites often called non-Israelite groups of people who belonged together "nations." Yahweh promised [Abraham](#) that Yahweh would [bless](#) all the nations of the earth through Abraham's descendants. We see that Yahweh kept his promise when Jesus' [disciples](#) shared the [good news](#) about Jesus not just to the Israelite nation but to all people groups.

Whenever the Bible talks about "all the nations of the earth," this is another way to say "all the people who live on earth."

nation

Audio Content

[mp3 file](#) (825573 KB)

Nazareth

Nazareth is a small town in the region of [Galilee](#), in the north of [Israel](#). Nazareth does not appear in the Old Testament, and the first time we hear about this town is when we hear that [Mary](#) and Joseph, Jesus's parents, came from Nazareth. Jesus was born in a village called [Bethlehem](#), in [Judea](#), but when he was still small Mary and Joseph went to live in Nazareth. Therefore Jesus was later called a Nazarene, which means someone from Nazareth. That was not a compliment. The [Jews](#) from Judea looked down on the people in Galilee, and even the people within Galilee looked down on people from Nazareth, because it was a small and unimportant town.

Nazareth

Audio Content

[mp3 file](#) (546356 KB)